



SUJET STATAPP 327 - 2026-2027



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Organisme : CREST

Catégorie : Sociologie Quantitative

Sujet :

Sharing or Separating? Trends in Income Pooling among Couples, 1988-2022. Analysis of the ISSP Family and Changing Gender Roles Module

Description du sujet :

Whether couples pool their income or keep it separate is a key marker of how institutionalized and equal a relationship is, and marriage in particular has long favored pooling (Präg, Begall, and Treas 2026). Yet recent research shows that couples' financial practices have grown more individualized over time, partly driven by digitalization and online banking (Hu 2021; Hu and Qian 2026).

This StatApp asks: How did income pooling change between the late 1980s and the early 2020s, and what drove this change? We will use five waves of the ISSP Family and Changing Gender Roles module (1988, 1994, 2002, 2012, 2022), which ask nationally representative samples in a growing set of countries how their household income is managed.

We will test whether change in pooling reflects individual-level factors?more dual-earner couples, cohabitation, and shifting relative earnings?as well as country-level factors such as female labor force participation, divorce rates, and gender-role attitudes (Pepin and Cohen 2021; Çineli 2022). Random-effects models will describe cross-national variation in pooling and its country-level correlates; fixed-effects models, exploiting the repeated cross-sections, will isolate within-country change net of time-constant country characteristics.

Statistical software will be Stata or R, depending on the students' preferences.

At the end of this project, students will have:

- An excellent understanding of random- and fixed-effects models for repeated cross-sectional, cross-national survey data
- An excellent understanding of the ISSP Family and Changing Gender Roles module, one of the longest-running cross-national data sources on gender and family life
- With effort, perseverance, and a bit of luck, the chance to publish an article in an international peer-reviewed journal

Données du sujet :

The Family and Changing Gender Roles module of the International Social Survey Programme (ISSP) is a cross-national survey on attitudes and behaviors related to gender roles, work, and family life. It has been fielded five times to date?in 1988, 1994, 2002, 2012, and 2022?with the number of participating countries growing from a handful in 1988 to more than 30 in the most recent wave. Each wave includes questions on household income management, alongside detailed information on respondents' and partners' employment, earnings, education, and attitudes toward gender roles. Data and documentation for each wave are freely available through GESIS: <https://www.gesis.org/en/issp/data-and-documentation/family-and-changing-gender-roles>, including the 1988, 1994, 2002, 2012, and 2022 waves.

Modèles envisagés du sujet :

Random-effects (multilevel) models, with individuals nested in country-waves nested in countries, to describe cross-national and over-time variation in income pooling and to test country-level predictors such as female labor force participation, divorce rates, and gender-role attitudes. Fixed-effects models exploiting the repeated cross-sections across waves to control for unobserved, time-constant country characteristics and isolate within-country change. Statistical software: Stata or R, depending on student preference.

Bibliographie du sujet :

Präg, Patrick, Katia Begall, and Judith Treas. 2026. "Understanding the Marriage?Cohabitation Gap in Income Pooling. Evidence from 29 European Countries." Working paper. This is closely related prior work on income pooling that motivates and contextualizes this StatApp.

Hu, Yang. 2021. "Divergent Gender Revolutions. Cohort Changes in Household Financial Management across Income Gradients." *Gender & Society* 35(5):746-777. doi: 10.1177/08912432211036912. This article documents cohort-based change over time in how couples manage money.

Hu, Yang, and Yue Qian. 2026. "Empowerment and Individualization. Online Banking and Household Financial Organization." *European Sociological Review*. doi: 10.1093/esr/jcag002. This article shows how digitalization has facilitated increasingly individualized money management over time.

Pepin, Joanna R., and Philip N. Cohen. 2021. "Nation-Level Gender Inequality and Couples' Income Arrangements." *Journal of Family and Economic Issues* 42(1):13-28. doi: 10.1007/s10834-020-09717-5. This article tests how country-level gender inequality shapes couples' income arrangements.

Çineli, Beyda. 2022. "Who Manages the Money at Home? Multilevel Analysis of Couples' Money Management Across 34 Countries." *Gender & Society* 36(1):32-62. doi: 10.1177/08912432211057920. This article uses multilevel models to explain cross-national variation in money management.

Notation du sujet :

Commentaires :